Northstar Industrial Supplies – TO-BE Checkout Process Map (Recommended)

Incremental improvements focused on clarity, safe recovery and decision support | Differences from AS-IS highlighted

Actor / System	1. Context & Cart	2. Address & Delivery	3. Payment & Submit	4. Confirmation & After
Customer (Buyer)	• Sign in / select account with clearer labels • Cart review with clearer availability meaning • Error messages state which rule failed (format / account / location)	• Select address • Delivery options shown • **When option changes:** short explanation of what triggered the change (qty / product / address / cutoff) so buyer can decide	• Enter payment • Submit • **While result unknown:** explicit “processing / determining status” state • Unsafe second submit blocked or clearly warned • Safe recovery actions only	• Confirmation page with order ID + immediate next-step info (shipment expectation if known) • Email consistent with page • Support can answer “did it go through?” faster
Northstar Systems	• Same context resolution • Improved error payloads for purchasing / account fields	• Same recalculation logic • Surface reason or trigger to UI when available • (If reason not returned → show “based on your latest change” + contact path)	• Submission identifier / idempotency handling • Clear state model: pending / authorised / declined / order-created / confirmation-sent • Front-end reflects known state only	• Order + notification as today • Better correlation of session / payment / order for Support view
Support / Finance / Ops	• Clearer account context on cases	• Can explain delivery change using same language customer saw	• Finance: visibility of attempt state before advising retry • Support: reduced “unknown first attempt” escalations	• Shared identifiers reduce investigation time • Duplicate risk assessed with evidence

Meaningful changes (Problem → Change → Benefit)

1. Uncertain submit / double-click risk → Explicit processing state + block or warn unsafe resubmit + submission identifier → Customer confidence; lower duplicate exposure; fewer Apex-type escalations.
2. Opaque delivery option changes → Show trigger / reason when available → Customer can make business decision without calling; lower Meridian-type friction.
3. Vague account / purchasing errors → Error text states which context rule failed → Fewer Orion-type abandonments; clearer Support diagnosis.
4. Confirmation without operational confidence → Enrich confirmation (within scope) with next-step / shipment expectation → Fewer Harborline-type post-submit contacts.
5. Fragmented investigation → Improve correlation of session / payment / order for Support → Faster, safer answers; less incorrect recovery advice.

Future considerations (not in initial recommendation)

- *Guest / lighter path for a defined subset of urgent low-risk purchases – requires further rule analysis with Finance, Ops and Sales.*
- *Full redesign of account selector or deep delivery-service reason taxonomy – longer-term; needs more evidence and design effort.*
- *End-to-end fulfilment tracking beyond confirmation scope – out of current mandate.*

Note: TO-BE stays incremental and evidence-based. No full redesign is assumed. Changes are traceable to story incidents and questionnaire findings. Unvalidated technical capabilities are not claimed.